



Followers are the lifeblood of a Twitter account. Without them, you might as well not exist on the website. They're rather fickle, too. They won't think twice before unfollowing you.

greater than 100,000 followers. This in itself reveals the fact that regular usage of this social networking site isn't a sure shot path to achieving some modicum of 'success'. This inevitable begs the question about 'success'. That is, how does one define a successful Twitter account? One of the key factors when discussing success is the follower count. Follower count is essentially the number of people who you can reach out to as soon as you tweet. Whether they then choose to share the content in any give way isn't something that can be predicted. So, to have as large an audience as possible, it is essential to have a large follower count.

Some of the easier, cost-effective ways of increasing the number of followers your twitter handle has are –

- ♦ **Use keywords.** This seems like an obvious answer to the follower problem, but it is surprisingly effective. A recent study showed that tweets from businesses that include hashtags are 33% more likely to be retweeted than ones without any hashtags. Keep in mind that here too, as with everything else in life, moderation is key. The same study showed that tweets with a single hashtag were 69% more likely to be retweeted than tweets with two hashtags.
- ♦ Another effective tool to advertise is the **Direct Message** feature that Twitter has. Even intuitively, a Direct Message (or a DM) seems more personal than any other form of mass marketing technique. This is,